

National Coverage Determination (NCD)

Treatment of Decubitus Ulcers

270.4

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

270.4

Manual Section Title

Treatment of Decubitus Ulcers

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

This is a longstanding national coverage determination. The effective date of this version has not been posted.

Description Information

Benefit Category

Physicians' Services

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

An accepted procedure for healing decubitus ulcers is to remove dead tissue from the lesions and to keep them clean to promote the growth of new tissue. This may be accomplished by hydrotherapy (whirlpool) treatments.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

Hydrotherapy (whirlpool) treatment for decubitus ulcers is a covered service under Medicare for patients when treatment is reasonable and necessary.

Some other methods of treating decubitus ulcers, the safety and effectiveness of which have not been established, are not covered under the Medicare program. Some examples of these types of treatments are: ultraviolet light, low intensity direct current, topical application of oxygen, and topical dressings with Balsam of Peru in castor oil.

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Treatment of Decubitus Ulcers	1	01/01/1966 - N/A	You are here